

# HIC-001 - Origin and Context

Status: DRAFT

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Related Standard: /governance/HIC-001\_Human-in-Command\_Standard.md

## Purpose

This support document summarizes how the Human-in-Command Standard emerged and how it should be understood.

This document is explanatory. It does not replace or override HIC-001.

## Origin

The Human-in-Command Standard emerged during development of the AgentForge ecosystem.

AgentForge began as an operational discipline for human-centered AI-assisted work, expressed through governed kits, workflows, structures, and orchestration patterns.

As the ecosystem matured, one principle became increasingly important:

Systems may assist operations.

Humans retain operational authority, judgment, and accountability.

The standard was intentionally compressed into a short, stable form so that it could apply across tools, training, workflows, projects, and future systems without becoming tied to one implementation.

## Why It Was Kept Short

HIC-001 is intended to function like a foundational governance principle.

It is not a procedure manual.

Implementation guidance, examples, operational patterns, compliance interpretation, and public communication assets may exist separately. Those materials may explain the standard, but they do not replace it.

This separation protects the standard from governance bloat.

## What Changed

Before HIC-001, human authority was implied through transparency, validation, traceability, and maintainability practices.

After HIC-001, human operational responsibility is explicit.

The standard gives projects a clear governance anchor:

Human-in-Command is a foundational operational requirement for responsible systems.

## How It Should Be Used

HIC-001 may be adopted by projects, workflows, kits, organizations, and operational environments that involve delegated, assisted, or automated processes.

A project may reference HIC-001 directly and then build its own implementation guidance beneath it.

The standard should remain stable. Supporting materials may evolve.

## **Development & Test Environment**

Platform: ChatGPT (Web)

Model: GPT-5.5

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Notes: Created as an initial support document for the -agentforge-governance repository.